

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF NEW YORK

SAID SALIM,

X

Plaintiffs,

COMPLAINT

-against-

PLAINTIFF DEMANDS
TRIAL BY JURY

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, LIEUTENANT
ADAM RAMOS, SERGEANT WILBERT CRAWLEY,
DETECTIVE MICHAEL CORBETT, LIEUTENANT
LOURON HALL, POLICE OFFICERS JOHN/JANE
DOE(S) #s 1-10,

Case No.

Defendants.

X

Plaintiff SAID SALIM for his complaint, by his attorney DAVID A. ZELMAN, ESQ.,
and upon information and belief respectfully alleges as follows:

I. PRELIMINARY STATEMENT

1. This is a civil rights action in which Plaintiff SAID SALIM (hereinafter "Plaintiff") seeks damages to redress the deprivation, under color of state law, of rights secured to him under New York State law. On or about April 30, 2014, Plaintiff was falsely arrested by employees of the City of New York. As a result of the violation of his constitutional rights, Plaintiff suffered physical and mental injuries.

II. JURISDICTION

2. This Court has jurisdiction over Plaintiff's state law claims.

III. PARTIES

3. Plaintiff at all times relevant hereto resided in the State of New York.
4. Defendant CITY OF NEW YORK (hereinafter "CITY") is a municipal corporation, incorporated pursuant to the laws of the State of New York, which operates the New

York City Police Department (hereinafter "NYPD"), and as such is the public employer of the Defendant officers herein.

5. Defendant LIEUTENANT ADAM RAMOS (hereinafter "RAMOS" or "Defendant") was a NYPD police officer, and at all times relevant hereto, acted in that capacity as agent, servant, and/or employee of Defendant CITY and within the scope of their employment. RAMOS is sued in his official and individual capacity.
6. Defendant SERGEANT WILBERT CRAWLEY (hereinafter "CRAWLEY" or "Defendant") was a NYPD police officer, and at all times relevant hereto, acted in that capacity as agent, servant, and/or employee of Defendant CITY and within the scope of their employment. CRAWLEY is sued in his official and individual capacity.
7. Defendant DETECTIVE MICHAEL CORBETT (hereinafter "CORBETT" or "Defendant") was a NYPD police officer, and at all times relevant hereto, acted in that capacity as agent, servant, and/or employee of Defendant CITY and within the scope of their employment. CORBETT is sued in his official and individual capacity.
8. Defendant LIEUTENANT LOURON HALL (hereinafter "HALL" or "Defendant") was a NYPD police officer, and at all times relevant hereto, acted in that capacity as agent, servant, and/or employee of Defendant CITY and within the scope of their employment. HALL is sued in his official and individual capacity.
9. Defendants POLICE OFFICERS JOHN/JANE DOE(S) (hereinafter "DOE(S)") were NYPD police officers, and at all relevant times hereto, acted in that capacity as agents, servants, and/or employees of Defendant CITY and within the scope of their employment. DOE(S) are sued in their official and individual capacity.

10. At all relevant times hereto, Defendants were acting under the color of state and local law. Defendants are sued in their individual and official capacities. At all relevant times hereto, Defendant CITY was responsible for making and enforcing the policies of NYPD and was acting under the color of law, to wit, under the color of the statutes, ordinances, regulations, policies, customs and usages of the State of New York and/or the City of New York.

IV. FACTS

11. Plaintiff is a NYPD detective and has consistently worked for the NYPD for more than six years.
12. On or about July 12, 2009, Plaintiff participated in an undercover operation. In the course of the operation, Plaintiff and another NYPD employee stopped two individuals.
13. During the stop of these two individuals, Plaintiff came to learn that one or both of the individuals were in possession of a large quantity of cocaine and/or other contraband.
14. Two arrests were made and Plaintiff signed a criminal court complaint, charging these two individuals with Felony Possession of Narcotics and related charges.
15. During the course of that criminal proceeding, both a grand jury hearing and pre-trial hearings were conducted. Plaintiff testified at both.
16. The criminal cases against the two criminal defendants were ultimately dismissed. On or about April 30, 2014, approximately four and half years following the undercover operation and approximately four years after Plaintiff's testimony at the grand jury hearing and the pre-trial hearing, Plaintiff was arrested by the within Defendants, including but not limited to Defendants CRAWLEY and HALL.

17. Plaintiff was brought to Manhattan Criminal Court. Plaintiff was charged with five counts of perjury and false instrument-related charges including: Offering a False Instrument for Filing in the First Degree, P.L. §175.35, Making a Punishable False Written Statement P.L. §210.45 and Official Misconduct P.L. §195.00(1). A grand jury convened. Plaintiff hired an attorney to represent him.
18. Plaintiff was required to make approximately 12 court appearances regarding the above charges and incurred substantial legal fees.
19. On or about March 24, 2015, Judge Konvisor of the New York County Supreme Court – Criminal Term Part 31 issued a decision dismissing all charges against Plaintiff. In her decision Judge Konvisor found that there was a complete lack of evidence with respect to the charges against plaintiff. Judge Konvisor determined that the District Attorney's failure to appropriately instruct the Grand Jury left the grand jurors 'rudderless', and unable to fulfill their function. It is alleged that defendants suppressed evidence in order obtain a Grand Jury indictment. This suppression consisted of failing and or refusing to inform the District Attorney's office and or the grand jurors that Plaintiff was innocent of the charges. Attached hereto is Exhibit A the full decision by Judge Konvisor.
20. It is alleged that the Defendants CORBETT, HALL, RAMOS, and CRAWLEY acting jointly attempted to build a case which they knew to be meritless against the Plaintiff in order to assuage public opinion that the NYPD was failing to police its own. Defendants knew that any arrest of a NYPD detective would generate tremendous publicity and in fact that did happen in this case. Defendants CORBETT, HALL, RAMOS, and CRAWLEY, sought this publicity for their own benefit and for their perceived benefit for the NYPD as a whole. There was substantial and compelling evidence during all stages

- of this investigation and proceeding that the Plaintiff had accurately and faithfully discharged his duties as a NYPD officer.
21. Defendants CORBETT, HALL, RAMOS, and CRAWLEY initiated a prosecution against the Plaintiff by bringing their fabricated report of alleged crimes to the District Attorney's office and thereafter testifying in front of the Grand Jury regarding those alleged crimes despite the fact that there was no evidence to support the charges and the defendants knew their report to be false. Upon information and belief one or more of the within named Defendants testified at the Grand Jury, and continued to attempt to build a misleading and meritless case against the Plaintiff, without any evidence of wrongdoing, following their participation at the Grand Jury by working closely with the District Attorney's office.
22. It is alleged that Plaintiff committed no crime and in fact diligently performed his job and testified regarding the street encounter to the best of his recollection. This matter has greatly affected Plaintiff's career in that Plaintiff was placed on modified duty and his salary was impacted.
23. That heretofore and on the 23th day of June, 2015, Plaintiff's Notice of Claim and Intention to sue was duly served upon and filed with the CITY; said Notice was filed within ninety (90) days after the cause of action herein accrued and set forth Plaintiff's name, the nature of the claim, the time and place of the incident, the manner in which the claim arose and the items of damage and injuries sustained.
24. That at least thirty (30) days have elapsed since the demand or claim upon which these actions are predicated was presented to CITY for adjustment or payment thereof and that it has neglected and/or refused to make adjustment or payment thereof.

25. That plaintiff filed these State law claims in the Southern District of New York on or about October 28, 2015 and the matter was assigned Case # 15-CV-8521. The matter was dismissed and the Court declined to exercise jurisdiction over plaintiff's state law claims on or about December 22, 2016. Therefore, this matter is timely filed within six months of the termination of the prior action pursuant to CPLR Section 205(a).

V. FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION
Pursuant to State Law (FALSE ARREST)

26. Paragraphs 1 through 25 of this complaint are hereby realleged and incorporated by reference herein.
27. That Defendants had neither valid evidence for the arrest of Plaintiff nor legal cause or excuse to seize and detain him.
28. That in detaining Plaintiff without a fair and reliable determination of probable cause, Defendant CITY abused its power and authority as a policymaker of the NYPD under the color of State and/or local law. It is alleged that CITY, via their agents, servants and employees routinely charged persons with crimes they did not commit. Plaintiff was but one of those persons.
29. Upon information and belief, it was the policy and/or custom of Defendant CITY to inadequately supervise and train its officers, staff, agents and employees, thereby failing to adequately discourage further constitutional violations on the part of their officers, staff, agents and employees.
30. As a result of the above described policies and customs, the officers, staff, agents and employees of Defendant CITY believed that their actions would not be properly monitored by supervisory officers and that misconduct would not be investigated or sanctioned, but would be tolerated.

31. The above described policies and customs demonstrated a deliberate indifference on the part of the policymakers of the CITY to the constitutional rights of arrestees and were the cause of the violations of Plaintiff's rights alleged herein.
32. By reason of Defendants acts and omissions, Defendant CITY, acting under color of state law and within the scope of its authority, in gross and wanton disregard of Plaintiff's rights, subjected Plaintiff to an unlawful detention, in violation of the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments of the United States Constitution and the laws of the State of New York.
33. By reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff suffered physical injuries, mental injuries, deprivation of liberty and privacy, terror, humiliation, damage to reputation and other psychological injuries. All of said injuries may be permanent.

VI. SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION

Pursuant to State Law (FAILURE TO INTERVENE)

34. Paragraphs 1 through 33 are hereby realleged and incorporated by reference herein.
35. That Defendants failed to intervene when Defendants knew or should have known that Plaintiff's constitutional rights were being violated.
36. That Defendants had a realistic opportunity to intervene on behalf of Plaintiff, whose constitutional rights were being violated in their presence.
37. That a reasonable person in the Defendants' position would know that Plaintiff's constitutional rights were being violated.
38. That by reason of Defendants' acts and omissions, Defendants, acting under the color of state law and within the scope of their authority, in gross and wanton disregard of Plaintiff's rights, deprived Plaintiff of his liberty when they failed to intervene to protect

him from Defendants' violation of Plaintiff's civil rights pursuant to the Fourteenth Amendment of the United States Constitution.

39. That upon information and belief, Defendants had a policy and /or custom of failing to intervene to protect citizens from excessive force by police officers. Thus, as a result of the above described policies and customs, Plaintiff was not protected from Defendants' unconstitutional actions.
40. That upon information and belief it was the policy and/or custom of Defendant CITY to inadequately hire, train, supervise, discipline and/or terminate their officers, staff, agents and employees, thereby failing to adequately discourage further constitutional violations on the part of their officers, staff, agents, and employees.
41. That as a result of the above described policies and customs, Defendant CITY, its staff, agents and employees of Defendant CITY believed that their actions would not be properly monitored by supervisory officers and that misconduct would not be investigated or sanctioned, but would be tolerated.
42. That the above described policies and customs demonstrate a deliberate indifference on the part of the policymakers of Defendant CITY to the constitutional rights of detainees and were the cause of the violations of Plaintiff's rights alleged herein.
43. That in so acting, Defendant CITY abused its power and authority as policymaker of the NYPD under the color of State and/or local law.
44. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff suffered physical and psychological injuries, traumatic stress, mental anguish, economic damages including attorney's fees, damage to reputation, shame, humiliation, and indignity. All of said injuries may be permanent.

VII. THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION

Pursuant to State Law (RESPONDEAT SUPERIOR)

45. Paragraphs 1 through 44 are hereby realleged and incorporated by reference herein.
46. That Defendants were acting in furtherance of the duties owed to their employer, defendant CITY.
47. That at all times Defendants were acting within the scope of their employment.
48. That Defendant CITY was able to exercise control over Defendants activities.
49. That Defendant CITY is liable for Defendants actions under the doctrine of respondeat superior. By reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff suffered physical injuries, mental injuries, emotional injuries, economic injury, trauma, humiliation, terror, damage to reputation, and other psychological injuries. All of said injuries may be permanent.

VIII. FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION

Pursuant to State Law (MALICIOUS PROSECUTION)

50. Paragraphs 1 through 49 are hereby realleged and incorporated by reference herein.
51. That Defendants acting with malicious intent, arrested Plaintiff and initiated a criminal proceeding despite the knowledge that he had committed no crime.
52. That the criminal charge against Plaintiff was terminated in his favor.
53. That there was no probable cause for the arrest and criminal proceeding.
54. That by reason of Defendants' acts and omissions, Defendants, acting under the color of state law and within the scope of their authority, in gross and wanton disregard of Plaintiff's rights, deprived Plaintiff of his liberty when they maliciously prosecuted him and subjected him to an unlawful, illegal and excessive detention, in violation of his rights pursuant to the Fourth and Fourteenth Amendments of the United States Constitution.
55. That upon information and belief, Defendants had a policy and /or custom of maliciously prosecuting individuals despite the lack of probable cause. Thus, as a result of the above

described policies and customs, Plaintiff was maliciously prosecuted despite the fact that he had committed no violation of the law.

56. That upon information and belief it was the policy and /or custom of defendant CITY to inadequately hire, train, supervise, discipline and /or terminate their officers, staff, agents and employees, thereby failing to adequately discourage further constitutional violations on the part of their officers, staff, agents, and employees.
57. That as a result of the above described policies and customs, defendant CITY, its staff, agents and employees of defendant CITY believed that their actions would not be properly monitored by supervisory officers and that misconduct would not be investigated or sanctioned, but would be tolerated.
58. That the above described policies and customs demonstrate a deliberate indifference on the part of the policymakers of Defendant CITY to the constitutional rights of arrestees and were the cause of the violations of Plaintiffs' rights alleged herein.
59. That in so acting, Defendant CITY abused its power and authority as policymaker of the NYPD under the color of State and/or local law.
60. That upon information and belief, in 2014, Defendant CITY had a policy or routine practice of alleging facts against persons for the purpose of charging crimes they did not commit.
61. That by reason of the foregoing, Plaintiff suffered physical and psychological injuries, traumatic stress, post-traumatic stress disorder, mental anguish, economic damages including attorneys' fees, damage to reputation, shame, humiliation, and indignity. All of said injuries may be permanent.

IX. FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION**Pursuant to State Law (DENIAL OF FAIR TRIAL/FABRICATED EVIDENCE)**

62. Paragraphs 1 through 61 are hereby realleged and incorporated by reference herein.
63. By fabricating evidence, defendants violated SALIM'S constitutional right to a fair trial.
64. Defendants were aware or should have been aware of the falsity of the information used to prosecute plaintiff.
65. That plaintiff sustained a deprivation of liberty as a result of the defendants fabrications including loss of liberty and being required to appear in Court on multiple occasions to answer to false and fabricated charges.
66. As a result of the above constitutionally impermissible conduct, plaintiff was caused to suffer personal injuries, violation of civil rights, economic damages, emotional distress, anguish, anxiety, fear, humiliation, loss of freedom and damage to his reputation and standing within his community.

INJURY AND DAMAGES

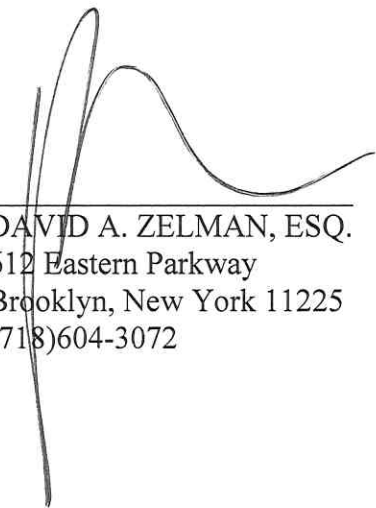
As a result of the acts and conduct complained of herein, Plaintiff has suffered and will continue to suffer economic injuries, physical pain, emotional pain, suffering, permanent disability, inconvenience, injury to his reputation, loss of enjoyment of life, loss of liberty and other non-pecuniary losses. Plaintiff has further experienced severe emotional and physical distress.

WHEREFORE, Plaintiff respectfully requests that judgment be entered:

1. Awarding Plaintiff compensatory damages in a full and fair sum to be determined by a jury;

2. Awarding Plaintiff punitive damages in an amount to be determined by a jury; and,
5. Granting such other and further relief as to this Court deems proper.

Dated: Brooklyn, New York
April 26, 2017



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